

I've often observed that while 100 percent of our business leaders describe integrity as the essential characteristic of leadership, less than 100 percent actually deliver on that claim.

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When I was in danger of losing my scholarship and having to leave Princeton during my sophomore year—struggling, at first unsuccessfully, with, yes, Paul Samuelson's *Economics: An Introductory Analysis* in my first course in what would become my major—I sure as heck pressed on. I graduated with high honors.

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Referring to the same passage from Ecclesiastes, Damon Runyon added this caution: "The race may not always be to the swift nor the battle to the strong, but that's the way to bet."

[21](#)

While we met only once, Postman knew enough about my own values to inscribe his book: "To Jack, whom I am delighted to have met in the 21st century, but who hasn't forgotten the glorious 18th century. A toast to common sense!"

[22](#)

You'll recognize, I think, the frequent appearances in this book of these final two themes.

[23](#)

I believe that without *The Federalist Papers*, numbering some 85 essays, our Constitution would have failed to gain approval by 9 of the 13 states that was required for its adoption. (It was ultimately ratified by all 13, although often by paper-thin margins.) Alexander Hamilton, author of 52 of the essays, chose the pen name *Publius*, after one of the founders and great generals of the Roman republic, whose name came to mean "friend of the people."

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Curiously, I don't ever recall thinking much about becoming a success in life, any more than I ever worried much about failure. I just never focused on those abstract ideas. Rather, I believed that if I